

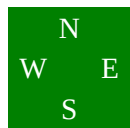
Board 1

South Deals

None Vul

♠ 8
 ♥ J 10 6 3 2
 ♦ A 8 5
 ♣ 8 4 3 2

♠ Q J 10 7
 ♥ K Q 9 8
 ♦ 7 6 2
 ♣ K Q



♠ A 5 4 2
 ♥ 5 4
 ♦ K Q 4 3
 ♣ 9 6 5

♠ K 9 6 3
 ♥ A 7
 ♦ J 10 9
 ♣ A J 10 7

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
			1 ♣
Pass	1 ♥	Pass	1 ♠
Pass	4 ♠		
All Pass			
4 ♠ by South			

When you have two 4-card suits to show you bid them "up-the-line". In this case it means you say 1 ♥. Partner replies 1 ♠.

There are enough points for game and a known 8-card Major fit. So you bid 4 ♠.

Perfect bidding isn't always rewarded. They can win three ♦ tricks and the Ace of trumps. If the opening lead is a ♥ or a ♣ you might make it, so it just depends on luck.

Board 3

North Deals

None Vul

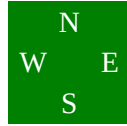
♠ 9 8 7 3
 ♥ A 8 5 3
 ♦ J 10 5
 ♣ 4 2

♠ K 10 4

♥ J 9 7

♦ A K 7 2

♣ K 5 3



♠ Q 6 2

♥ Q 4 2

♦ 4 3

♣ Q J 10 8 7

♠ A J 5

♥ K 10 6

♦ Q 9 8 6

♣ A 9 6

*West**North**East**South*

1 ♦

Pass

2NT

Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by South

You have two very good choices, neither of which is really wrong. You could bid 2NT, showing 13-16 points, balanced, or you could bid 3♦, showing 13-16 points, good trump support.

What should decide you is the bidding priorities. You'd much rather try to play a 9-trick game than an 11-trick game. And at the same time you must trust your partner not to leave you hung out in Notrump with an unsuitable hand. (Can you believe I wrote Notrump and unsuitable in the same sentence?)

Anyway, you bid 2NT and partner raises to 3NT.